

Disciplinary and Grievance Policy

Policy ID: HR-DG-11 · Effective: 1 January 2026 · Owner: People Operations

Company: Nilebyte Solutions (fictional company, dummy data for a portfolio project)

1. Principles

1.1 Disciplinary action must be fair, consistent and proportionate. Employees are told about the allegation in writing and can respond before any decision is made.

1.2 An employee may be accompanied by a colleague of their choice at any formal disciplinary or grievance meeting.

2. Disciplinary Stages

2.1 Stage 1: a verbal warning, kept on file for 6 months.

2.2 Stage 2: a first written warning, kept on file for 12 months.

2.3 Stage 3: a final written warning, kept on file for 18 months.

2.4 Gross misconduct, such as theft, violence, harassment or a serious data breach, may lead to dismissal without prior warnings, after an investigation.

2.5 An employee may be suspended on full pay while alleged gross misconduct is investigated. Suspension is not a disciplinary sanction.

3. Appeals

3.1 An employee may appeal any disciplinary decision in writing within 5 working days. The appeal is heard by a manager who was not previously involved.

4. Grievances

4.1 Employees should first raise a concern informally with their manager. If it is not resolved, or if it concerns the manager, they may raise a formal grievance in writing with HR.

4.2 HR holds a grievance meeting within 10 working days of receiving a formal grievance, and confirms the outcome in writing within 5 working days of the meeting.

4.3 Harassment and discrimination complaints may also be raised through the Ethics Hotline (Code of Conduct §2.1).